

Goldman Sachs Summer Analyst — The Real Process

London / EMEA · targeting the 2027 Summer Analyst Programme · the truth, not the brochure

 **Timing that matters right now:** the 2027 EMEA Summer Analyst application opens 15 August 2026 — i.e. **tomorrow**, as this is written on 14 Aug 2026. Review is **rolling with no fixed deadline**, and early application is a real, repeatedly-cited edge. If you're eligible, getting in during the **first 1–2 weeks** is one of the highest-leverage things you can do.

1. Eligibility — which year do you actually need to be in?

Official rule: Summer Analyst is for students *currently pursuing a Bachelor's or Master's* in their **penultimate or final year of study**.

The graduation-year maths for a summer-2027 London intake:

Your degree	Graduating	In 2026–27 you are	Your primary target
3-year UK degree	2028	Year 2 (penultimate)	2027 SA — this cycle (opens 15 Aug 2026) 
4-year (placement/abroad/Scottish MA)	2028	Year 3 (penultimate)	2027 SA — this cycle 
3-year UK degree	2027	Final year	Eligible, but converts to full-time not a return offer — you're the secondary cohort
4-year / integrated Master's	2029	Year 1–2	2028 SA is your natural target; 2026–27 = spring-week territory, not SA

- **If you graduate in 2028, the cycle opening tomorrow is squarely yours.**
- **If you graduate in 2029, verify carefully** — you're most likely a 2028 Summer Analyst candidate and a *spring-week* candidate now. Applying to SA a year early is generally a wasted application.
- **Discipline:** officially *school-agnostic, major-agnostic*. Any degree is accepted for front-office; Engineering expects coding ability (not necessarily a CS degree).
- **Grades:** Goldman publishes **no formal UCAS tariff or 2:1 cut-off** on its UK pages. The *effective* bar is very high (see §6). (*Confidence: medium — absence of a stated minimum is confirmed; the real bar is inferred from forums.*)
- **Visa/right to work:** the London office historically sponsors international summer analysts; the 2025 intern class spanned 90+ nationalities. **Confirm sponsorship wording on the live role listing.** (*Confidence: medium.*)

Source: [Goldman EMEA Summer Analyst page](#) · [Prepare page](#)

2. How many people actually apply — and the odds

These are **global, firmwide Summer Analyst** figures (Goldman does **not** publish EMEA/London-only counts):

Class	Applications (global)	Interns hired	Acceptance rate
2022	236,000 (record then)	—	~1.5%
2024	315,126	~2,700	0.9% (first sub-1%)
2025	360,000+ (record; +300% vs 2018)	~2,600	0.7%
2026	not disclosed	~2,500	below 1% (3rd straight year)

- A decade ago the rate was ~5%. The collapse to **sub-1%** is the whole story. Landing this is, by the numbers, rarer than a place at many elite programmes — Fox Business framed 2025 as "harder than becoming a NASA astronaut."
- 2025 class drawn from **500+ universities, 90+ nationalities**.
- **CEO David Solomon (2025)**: AI will "to some degree reduce the number of people that we start with... but probably not dramatically. We're still going to hire a lot of people out of school."
- **London caveat**: no reliable EMEA/London-only acceptance rate exists publicly. London IBD / Global Banking & Markets is *widely regarded* as **more** competitive than the global average (few seats, dense target-school pool) — but that's qualitative. Distrust any specific "London rate = X%."

Source: [Fortune 2022](#) · [Fortune 2026 \(acceptance <1%\)](#) · [Unusual Whales](#)

3. The full process, stage by stage (London SA)

Stage 0 — Where you apply (the platform)

- Public entry: **goldmansachs.com/careers/students**. Individual roles live on Goldman's **own applicant system, higher.gs.com** (e.g. `higher.gs.com/roles/...`) — **not** a third-party like Workday.
- Your CV is **parsed by an ATS**. The application captures personal/education details, **division + location choices**, languages, CV upload, and **word-limited motivation/competency questions** (historically ~300 words) — see §7 on what this means for your "cover letter."

Stage 1 — Online aptitude tests — ⚠️ genuinely uncertain, read carefully

This is the most contradicted point across sources: - **Test-prep vendors** claim a **numerical test (~20Q/20min)** + **verbal test (~10Q)**, and for **Engineering a HackerRank coding test** (2–4 problems, 120–180 min). - **But Goldman's own "Prepare" page** describes the flow as **Application → HireVue video → Superday**, with **no standalone aptitude test** for standard/front-office roles (only Engineering's HackerRank). Recent EMEA forum accounts (2024–26) mostly report going **straight from application to HireVue**. - **Most likely current reality**: for **front-office / most business divisions in EMEA**, there is **no separate timed numerical/verbal test in recent cycles** — the HireVue is the first automated hurdle. Vendor prep pages are partly legacy / partly conflated with other banks. **Engineering does get HackerRank**. - Goldman does **not** use pymetrics/game-based tests (that's other banks). - (Confidence: medium — commercially-motivated vendors disagree with Goldman's official page + recent forums. Verify on your specific role.)

Stage 2 — The HireVue video interview (you specifically asked how this is accessed)

How you get it / who gets it — the honest version: - Official wording: "If your application is selected, you will be asked to participate in a video interview." The invite arrives as an **emailed link to HireVue (hirevue.com)**; you complete it **in your browser, asynchronously**, within a deadline. - On "the HireVue is selective, how do they access it": officially there's a CV screen first ("if selected"). **In EMEA practice in recent cycles the CV screen before HireVue has been light — a large share of complete, eligible applicants receive the HireVue link within days to ~1–3 weeks.** So the **HireVue itself is the first heavy screen**, not the CV step before it. - **There is no hidden portal or insider unlock.** The link is triggered simply by submitting a **complete application to an eligible role**. The only real levers are: apply **early**, submit a **complete, tailored** application, and **network via My GS Events / a referral** to make sure your CV gets a proper look. - Once invited, you typically get a **short window (~24–48h up to a week)** to finish it. - (*Confidence: medium — the "most eligible applicants get the HireVue" pattern is well-attested on WSO/Reddit for EMEA but is not stated officially and can tighten in any given year.*)

Format: - **Asynchronous, pre-recorded, one-way.** Roughly **3–6 questions** (some report up to 7), **~30 min total. ~30 seconds to prepare**, up to **~2 minutes to answer** each. - **Content varies by division:** front-office = behavioural/competency + light commercial (e.g. "explain what an investment bank does in your own words," motivation, teamwork/leadership stories, markets awareness); **Engineering = HackerRank coding** instead of/alongside the video. - **Treat it as a real interview, not a formality** — because so many people receive it, it's where a large fraction are cut.

Stage 3 — Superday / final round

- Official: "If selected following your HireVue, you'll be invited to a series of final round interviews," and Goldman runs "**between two and five interviews for campus hires, depending on the division.**"
- Typical London shape: **multiple back-to-back ~30–45 min interviews** with **Analysts, Associates and VPs** (often ~3 interviewers). **Behavioural + technical** (IB: accounting/valuation/markets; Markets: mental maths, brainteasers, commercial awareness; internal: competency + problem-solving). Can include **case studies, group exercises or focus groups**.
- One secondary source cites **~25% of Superday attendees getting offers** — *indicative only. (Confidence: low.)*

Stage 4 — Timeline (2027 cycle)

- **Opens: 15 Aug 2026. Rolling review, no fixed deadline** — Goldman says "apply as soon as you are ready," and roles are typically cut off in a **Sept–Nov window** as they fill.
- **Early submission is a genuine, repeated advantage — target the first 1–2 weeks.**
- Approximate stage timing (secondary-source model, *not official*; individuals move faster if they apply early):
HireVue ~Oct–Nov 2026 → interviews ~Nov–Dec 2026 → Superday ~Jan–Feb 2027 → offers ~Feb–Mar 2027. (*Confidence: medium.*)

4. Divisions & how many you can apply to

London SA divisions (the official page lists ~18 teams; the main ones): - **Global Banking & Markets** — the merged division covering **Investment Banking (Advisory/Coverage)** and **FICC & Equities (Sales & Trading)**

- **Asset & Wealth Management** · **Engineering** (HackerRank) · **Global Investment Research** · **Risk** · **Operations** · **Controllers/Finance** · **Compliance, Legal, Internal Audit, Human Capital Management, Corporate Treasury, Tax**, etc.

How many applications per cycle — sources conflict: - Some guides say **up to 2 divisions / 3 locations**; others say **up to ~4 business+location combinations per recruiting year**, with a **5th auto-withdrawing an earlier one**. - **Working assumption:** **~3–4 role/location combinations max — don't spam. Check the exact count the portal shows you when you apply.** (*Confidence: medium.*)

Is it one reused cover letter? No — and this matters for your plan (see §7). You pick division(s)+location(s) and answer **division-specific motivation/competency questions**. Screeners look for "*specific division work, named deals or themes, a clear 'why this team'*" — **reusing identical generic essays across four applications is a named top rejection cause.**

Source: [EMEA SA page](#) · [Finbound guide](#) · [Career Principles](#)

5. Every website / platform, per stage

Stage	Platform
Info / prep	goldmansachs.com/careers/students · /prepare
Apply (the actual role)	higher.gs.com (Goldman's own ATS)
Networking / recruiter visibility	My GS Events (register for virtual/in-person events)
Video interview	HireVue (hirevue.com) — emailed async link
Coding test (Engineering)	HackerRank
Aptitude test (if used for your role)	third-party vendor in the flow (see §3 uncertainty)

On "insider" access to selective stages: there is **no hidden portal**. HireVue and Superday are **invite-by-email**, triggered by progressing the funnel. Legitimate levers: **(a)** apply early in the rolling window, **(b)** a complete, tailored application, **(c)** networking via My GS Events and, where possible, an **internal referral** — forums (Blind/WSO) note referrals materially help a CV get a proper read, especially for non-targets.

6. Recent changes & the forum "truths" the brochure won't tell you

What's changed (2024–26): - **Volume up, odds down:** 360k+ applications (2025), **0.7%** acceptance, third straight sub-1% year. The screen is tighter than ever → early + tailored matters more. - **AI warning:** Goldman EMEA campus recruiting has **warned students against using ChatGPT/AI to answer HireVue and interview questions** — they watch for canned AI answers. **Write in your own voice.** ([Fortune, Jun 2025](#)) - **Reorg:** Investment Banking + Global Markets now sit under unified **Global Banking & Markets**. - **DEI:** Goldman has **softened formal DEI metrics/targets (2025)**; diversity insight programmes still exist as pipelines but the framing is lighter.

Forum truths (well-attested, *not* official — treat with judgement): - **Target-school reality (London):** officially "school-agnostic." On WSO, London front-office is described as **elitist — dominated by**

LSE/Oxbridge/Warwick/HEC and top European schools, with non-target CVs often triaged into a separate stream. **A referral and a spring week materially help**, and non-target success stories do exist. (*Confidence: medium — strong anecdotal consensus, no official confirmation.*) - **Spring weeks / insight programmes = the fast-track**: Goldman EMEA runs early pipelines — the **Possibilities Series**, a **Virtual Insight Series**, and a **Future Possibilities Insight Event** (Year 12–13). **Strong spring-week/insight performers are widely reported to get fast-tracked toward Summer Analyst** — one of the most reliable routes in, especially for non-targets. (*If you're a 2029 grad, spring 2026/27 is high-value — don't skip it.*) - **ATS keyword screening**: CVs are parsed — mirror the role's language, name specific deals/teams/products, avoid generic motivation text. - **The rolling deadline is real and punishing**: waiting for a "deadline" that doesn't formally exist is a common self-inflicted rejection. **Apply in the first 1–2 weeks.**

7. What this means for your "cover letter" (important)

You planned **one cover letter reused across roles**. The research adds an important wrinkle:

- Goldman's application is built around **division-specific, word-limited motivation questions (historically ~300 words)** rather than a single free-form letter, and you can hold **~3–4 division/location applications** at once.
 - **Reusing one generic block across all of them is a flagged rejection cause.**
 - **So the right model is**: build **one master narrative** (your story + the insight-day hook + why Goldman — the Structure-B letter from Deliverable 1) as the **spine**, then **lightly re-point the final "why this team" beat** for each division you apply to. The hook, the story, and the culture-mirroring stay constant; only the last division-specific sentence(s) flex.
 - This keeps you inside Sam's philosophy (the firm-level story is the reusable engine) **and** satisfies Goldman's "why this specific team" screen.
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8. Your action checklist

1. **Confirm your graduation year** against §1. If 2028 → this cycle is yours. If 2029 → check whether you should be doing **spring weeks** instead.
 2. **Tomorrow (15 Aug 2026)**: open the live role on **higher.gs.com** — it shows the **exact application cap**, whether your role has an **online test**, and current **visa/eligibility** wording for London. Verify the medium-confidence items against it.
 3. **Decide your ~3–4 division/location combinations** (don't spam).
 4. **Apply early** — first 1–2 weeks.
 5. **Register for My GS Events**; chase a **referral** if you can.
 6. **Prep the HireVue as a real interview**, in your own voice (no AI answers).
 7. Send me your **CV + insight-day transcripts** → I write the master Structure-B letter + the per-division "why this team" variants.
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Confidence summary

- **High:** penultimate/final-year eligibility; 15 Aug 2026 open date; rolling review; global application/acceptance numbers + Solomon quote; HireVue = async/emailed/3–6 questions; Superday = 2–5 interviews with Analysts–VPs; higher.gs.com + HireVue + HackerRank platforms; tailor-per-division; sub-1% odds.
- **Medium (verify on the live portal):** whether a standalone numerical/verbal test still exists for EMEA front-office (likely not, except Engineering's HackerRank); exact application cap (2 vs 4); the "most eligible applicants get the HireVue" pattern; visa specifics; target-school + spring-week-fast-track claims.
- **Low / indicative only:** month-by-month stage calendar; the "~25% Superday-to-offer" figure; any London-specific acceptance rate (none reliably exists).

Compiled 14 Aug 2026 from: Goldman official EMEA SA & Prepare pages, higher.gs.com; Fortune (2022/2025/2026), Fox Business, Unusual Whales; Career Principles, Finbound, ECS, GraduatesFirst; WSO London SA thread, Team Blind, Prism News. Full URLs inline above.